well but do not let us anticipate, in two months more I will send you some more decided news. Write me every information you possibly can with regard to silk every body says it must rise and is the safest possible article for speculation, but I depend much upon your advice on this point.

We are both in excellent health and spirits. E. stands travelling remarkably well and is getting on with Turkish — he will fill up this as I am exceedingly busy.

[*Postscript by* EDWARD BURGESS*]

However we arrived in safety at Trebisond and found that the plague was over except in two houses but that it had been very bad and had carried off upward of 3000 people. In the Caravanserai where our goods were, we were told that four hundred men had died within the last three months. At Trebisond we were very kindly received by M. Fontanie the French Consul, Mr. Brant the English Consul being gone to Erzeroum; and we remained in his house whilst at Trebisond. From Trebisond here our road has lain entirely among mountains until within twenty miles of Erzeroum when we came onto the plain (entirely covered with snow and surrounded on every side by snow mountains) at the end of which stands the town. Here we proceeded to the house of Mr. Zorab, a Levantine, who is employed by the British Consul at Trebisond and stationed here. I am now writing in a room of his house.

The house belonged to one of the unfortunate Armenians who went away with the Russians when they gave this place back to the Turks. These poor people, all of whom were living in comfort and many of them in affluence here, were some of them persuaded by the Russians' promises, and at last when they (the Russians) found that many would stay they *drove them out of the town with whips and forced them* to follow the army, since that time they have been living in tents and have been subject to the greatest privations. Some have returned but these are very few as the Russians will not allow them to do so if they can prevent it. Fifty thousand people have thus most cruelly been forced to leave house and home. The consequence is that this place is almost ruined and instead of being the capital of Asia Minor as it ought from its situation to be, and as it has in great measure formerly, it is a desolate place the houses in ruins and the remaining part of the people as poor as rats.

* The rest of Edward's letters will follow those of Charles, in chronological order.

Erzerum was captured by the Russian general Paskievicz in 1829 and restored to Turkey after the Treaty of Adrianople. The shake-up in pashas referred to here by Edward was due to the invasion of Syria by the Egyptian pasha, Mehemet Ali. Edward was right; the new pasha never raised the ambitious levy he had announced, and consequently played no very important role in the struggle with Mehemet Ali.

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